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Ho Chi Minh City

#

* # Ho Chi Minh City

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Overview

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Vibrating with energy, innovation and traffic ? lots of traffic ? Ho Chi Minh City, formerly known as Saigon, is the economic heart of Vietnam and the main hub of the southern region. A freewheeling, cosmopolitan metropolis, HCMC's dynamic cityscape draws together old and new Vietnam in the most compact of spaces, representing the city?s past as well as its future. This city has many well-known attractions, including the War Museum, Notre Dame Cathedral Basilica, and Ben Thanh Market.

Let's dive into this guide and discover what to explore in this city to make your ****Ho Chi Minh City tour**** the most valuable!

Click the image below for a 360-degree tour of HCMC

****Top things to do in Ho Chi Minh City****

****See the top landmarks****

Walk down ??ng Kh?i street to acquaint yourself with the Notre Dame Cathedral, the city's Central Post Office, and the Saigon Opera House. On a more local level, B?n Thành Market and the Jade Emperor Pagoda are worth a visit.

****Shop small boutiques****

Around District 1, a host of old apartments and former office buildings have been repurposed as shopping

centres. Decades-old buildings such as 22 Lý T? Tr?ng and 42 Nguy?n Hu? are brimming with all kinds of fascinating stores.

****Explore the Chinese Quarter****

The Chinese neighbourhood known as Ch? L?n is great for exploring on foot. Head for Bình Tây Market, a colossal wholesale trading centre, and Thiên H?u Pagoda, an atmospheric temple that pays homage to the goddess of the sea.

****Hop on a motorcycle****

Do as the locals do and hop on the back of a motorbike to see the city on street level and feel its energetic pulse. Motorbike tours set off in the evening, when the city is at its most romantic and the sidewalk vendors are out in force.

****Eat street food****

Ho Chi Minh City locals love to gather around dented metal tables across the city for incredible roadside feasts. Don't miss highlights such as bánh mì, southern-style savoury pancakes *(bánh xèo)* and broken rice *(c?m t?m)*.

Ho Chi Minh City Weather

Ho Chi Minh City has consistent temperatures year-round, and the weather is generally warm. Heatwaves hit the city from April to May, welcoming the rainy season from May to November. Slightly cooler temperatures emerge in December and January.

Ho Chi Minh City Transport

Travellers can arrive in Ho Chi Minh City by bus, train or plane. Tan Son Nhat international airport welcomes foreign and domestic arrivals daily, while various bus companies operate shuttles from Phnom Penh and destinations across Vietnam. Ho Chi Minh City also sees a steady stream of train travellers. Taxis are everywhere, but those with a Vietnamese SIM card can use ride-hailing apps like Grab. Local buses cover a good portion of the city. Travellers can also take a boat along the river, for a day trip to C? Chi Tunnels or the Mekong Delta.

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